

Labours of Heracles

This is the tale of the greatest and strongest of all heroes – Heracles [HAIR-a-kleez]. He was the son of Zeus, but his mother was a mortal woman. Hera was extremely jealous of Heracles. He grew into a determined, wise young man with superhuman strength and skill.

Zeus wanted his son to become a god when he died. Hera replied, “I will only agree to this if Heracles can perform twelve labours to be set by his cousin Eurystheus [you-RIS-thee-us], the king of Mycenae [my-SEE-nee]”.

Super strong

As Heracles lay in his cot,
Hera sent serpents to kill him.
Even though he was only a
baby, Heracles strangled
them with his bare hands.

